

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

These two Letters to the Editor appeared in a local newspaper:

Too Few Bus Lanes	More Congestion and Pollution
I am writing to ask why there are so few bus lanes in Hong Kong. There is only 22 km of road reserved for buses, yet nearly 40% of people travel to work and school by bus. The heavy traffic means that bus travel is slow, which increases the amount of pollution at our roadsides. Many people avoid using buses because they are so slow. I believe the government should urgently create bus priority lanes. They should also consider introducing extra bus lanes during peak hours. Alternatively they could ask private car owners to pay tolls or apply for a permit to use certain roads. Something needs to be done to decrease bus journey times and make bus travel more convenient. John Wong, Kwun Tong	Hong Kong is a small city and there are limits to the number of roads and lanes we have. If we introduced bus lanes, it would lead to even worse pollution. There would be less space for cars so there would be more traffic jams than now. This would be unfair to people who drive private cars. Many people have to drive private cars for their work. They would have a lot of inconvenience. Taxis, lorries and other road users would also suffer. Hong Kong is just not a place where you can introduce more bus lanes. Peter Li, Wan Chai

Your class is going to debate the motion: 'More bus lanes are needed in Hong Kong.' Your group is preparing for the debate. You may want to talk about:

- whether buses are a convenient form of travel
- whether bus lanes are a suitable solution to traffic congestion
- other solutions to the traffic congestion problems
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like taking the bus?
2. What don't you like about buses?
3. Do you prefer the bus or the MTR?
4. How do you spend the time when you are on the bus?
5. Do you think Hong Kong has a good bus service?
6. Do you think road congestion is bad in Hong Kong?
7. What kinds of improvements can be made to bus services?
8. Are buses the cause or solution to the traffic congestion in Hong Kong?